

F5 Daily Briefing - Friday, August 14 - Sunday, August 16, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

19

ANNOUNCEMENTS

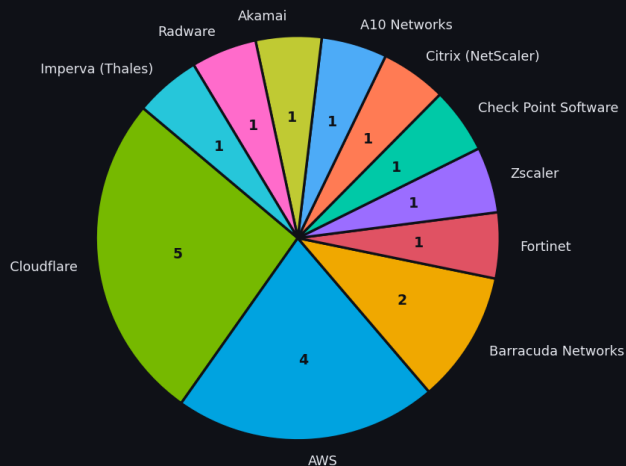
11

ACTIVE

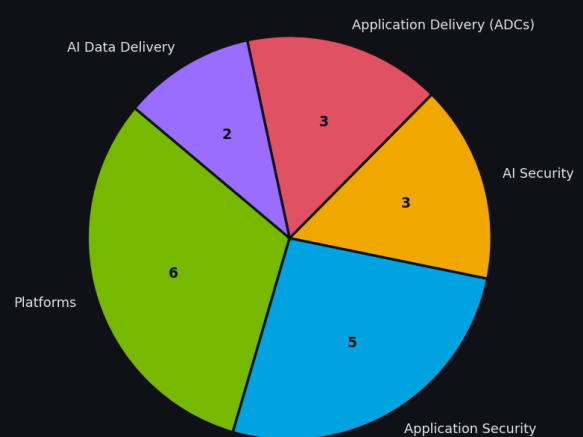
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

Announcement **Cloudflare** Aug 16, 2026

Cloudflare Wallets Aims to Automate API Payments for AI Agents

Cloudflare is building Wallets to let AI agents pay for metered APIs autonomously using the x402 standard, which returns HTTP 402 Payment Required with base64-encoded JSON payment instructions. The design pairs Cloudflare's monetization gateway with per-agent virtual wallets and spending policies to cap overspending. Named payment rails include Visa, Mastercard, Adyen, and Stripe, with EVM stablecoin support planned. The wallet side remains early: only handle reservation and screenshots exist so far, positioning Cloudflare for agentic commerce.

Source: <https://www.heise.de/en/news/Cloudflare-Wallets-Automated-API-payments-for-AI-agents-11415424.html>

Product Launch **Imperva (Thales)** Aug 16, 2026

Imperva Cloud Application Security August 16, 2026 Release: Cloud WAF, AI Application Security and API Security Updates

Thales published weekly release notes for Imperva Cloud Application Security. Cloud WAF gains error-code drill-down on the Performance dashboard and a new metric in the Website Performance Statistics API. AI Application Security adds Management API documentation to automate AI security operations. API Security introduces a downloadable BOLA Vulnerability Validation Script so teams can verify BOLA findings against live endpoints and distinguish true from false positives via Risk Validation. Newly mitigated CVEs include CVE-2025-6440 and CVE-2026-63077.

Source: <https://docs-cybersec.thalesgroup.com/bundle/cloud-application-security/page/release-notes/2026-08-16.htm>

Product Launch**Cloudflare**

Aug 15, 2026

Cloudflare Adds Agent Tracing for AI Agent Observability

Cloudflare shipped Agent Tracing, the first component of Cloudflare Agents, layering agent-level spans on existing Workers tracing to capture agent invocations, model calls, tool execution, approvals, and token metadata. It includes session replay of conversations covering messages, reasoning, and tool arguments and results, replaying recorded data rather than re-executing agents. Coverage notes inconsistent payload-recording defaults across harnesses and truncation limits, raising privacy considerations. The beta is free through October 1, 2026, then folds into Workers Observability pricing.

Source: <https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/08/cloudflare-agent-tracing/>

Product Launch**Cloudflare**

Aug 15, 2026

Cloudflare Introduces Cache Response Rules for Post-Origin Cache Control

Cloudflare launched Cache Response Rules, a rules engine that runs after the origin responds but before content is written to Cloudflare's cache. Operators can modify cache-related headers such as Cache-Control, manage cache tags, and strip Set-Cookie, ETag, or Last-Modified headers without changing origin applications. Caching now follows a two-phase model: request-time Cache Rules decide whether and how to look up and fetch from cache, while Cache Response Rules shape what is ultimately stored and served.

Source: <https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/08/cloudflare-cache-rules/>

Product Launch**AWS**

Aug 15, 2026

AWS Lambda Introduces Public Preview Runtimes with Node.js 26 and Python 3.15

AWS Lambda added public preview runtimes so developers can test new language versions before general availability, beginning with Node.js 26 and Python 3.15. Previews are available in all commercial Regions plus GovCloud and China, use the same runtime identifiers, and graduate automatically to GA when stable. Previews follow the GA patch cadence and support all Lambda features, but may include breaking changes and are excluded from SLA and AWS Support. Standard Lambda pricing applies; feedback runs through GitHub issues.

Source: <https://aws-news.com/article/2026-08-15-introducing-public-preview-runtimes-on-aws-lambda-starting-with-nodejs-26-and-python-315>

Financial**Check Point Software**

Aug 15, 2026

Check Point Signals AI Security Spending Ramp Heading Into 2027

Check Point told investors that AI-related security spending should accelerate in 2027 as enterprises move from experimentation to dedicated budgets, according to Global Head of Investor Relations Kip Meintzer. Customers have been redirecting current-year budgets toward AI initiatives, with formal AI security line items expected in 2027 planning cycles. Management described mixed Q2 execution during a go-to-market transition but stayed optimistic on Q3 and Q4 pipeline and guidance, and plans roughly 300 hires by year-end for a stronger 2027 start.

Source: <https://www.themarketsdaily.com/2026/08/15/check-point-sees-ai-security-spending-surge-as-2027-growth-setup-takes-shape.html>

Product Launch **Akamai** Aug 15, 2026

Akamai Unveils Workforce Protector as New AI Threat Research Flags Enterprise Shadow AI Risks

Akamai's Workforce Protector (formerly LayerX) drew fresh weekend coverage, pairing AI usage governance with real-time data loss prevention and extending Akamai's security platform to browsers and desktop AI apps. The product discovers shadow AI, enforces adaptive policy inside user workflows, and blocks sensitive data from reaching unauthorized models, complementing SSE, CASB, and DLP tools. Akamai simultaneously published AI threat research on emerging enterprise risks including Vibe hacking, CursorJacking, and CometJacking, reinforcing its pivot from maturing CDN revenue toward security.

Source: <https://au.finance.yahoo.com/news/akamai-technologies-akam-unveils-workforce-170801552.html>

Research **Barracuda Networks** Aug 15, 2026

Barracuda Research: Email Threats Are Learning to Look Legitimate

Barracuda researchers reported that email threat campaigns are growing stealthier by abusing legitimate services and stolen session tokens to bypass both technical defenses and user training. The analysis describes attackers hiding intent from scanners, leaning on trusted platforms, and moving past password theft toward session-based abuse, including device code phishing and click-attack techniques that blend into normal user activity. Barracuda positioned detection of anomalous session and identity behavior as essential.

Source: <https://smbtech.au/thought-leadership/the-attacks-hiding-in-plain-sight-how-email-threats-are-learning-to-look-legitimate/>

Announcement **Fortinet** Aug 14, 2026

Fortinet Patches Critical FortiWeb Authentication Bypass and FortiManager Impersonation Flaws

Fortinet disclosed patches for eight vulnerabilities, headlined by CVE-2026-26035 in FortiWeb, where an unauthenticated remote attacker can log into the WAF's GUI or CLI with arbitrary credentials when the wildcard administrator setting is enabled. Fixes shipped in FortiWeb 8.0.3, 7.6.7, 7.4.12 and 7.2.13. A FortiManager authentication bypass (CVE-2026-70468) lets attackers impersonate managed FortiGate devices, and a FortiClient for Windows buffer overflow (CVE-2026-70465) permits code execution via crafted DNS responses. CISA has separately warned of active attacks against FortiOS.

Source: <https://www.heise.de/en/news/Fortinet-FortiWeb-Attackers-can-log-in-with-any-credentials-11414224.html>

Product Launch **Cloudflare** Aug 14, 2026

Cloudflare One Detects and Governs MCP Traffic on the Wire

Cloudflare introduced Cloudflare One capabilities that identify Model Context Protocol traffic at the protocol level by inspecting the MCP-Protocol-Version header during TLS inspection, rather than relying on hostnames. A new MCP dashboard shows total requests, unique users and servers, per-server activity, and whether calls arrive via approved MCP Server Portals or bypass them. New Gateway traffic-source selectors let admins block shadow MCP connections that skip approved portals, extending DLP and HTTP policy enforcement to agentic AI traffic.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/mcp-security-updates/>

Product Launch **Cloudflare** Aug 14, 2026

Cloudflare Access Can Now Be Enabled on a Single Worker or All Workers at Once

Cloudflare added two ways to protect Workers with Access. Policies can now attach directly to a Worker, covering all of its domains and preview URLs so route or domain changes stay protected without manual updates. Accounts can also make every existing and new Worker private by default, with optional per-Worker bypasses to keep specific Workers public. Admins tailor sign-in by Cloudflare account membership, email, or domain, and choose whether protection applies to previews, production, or both.

Source: <https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-08-14-workers-access/>

Partnership**AWS**

Aug 14, 2026

AppFolio Names AWS Its Preferred Cloud Provider

AppFolio designated Amazon Web Services its preferred cloud provider, running its Performance Platform and AI-native Realm AI suite, including Realm-X, on AWS. The property-management software company serves nearly 23,000 customers and cited reliability, security, and continued innovation as drivers. CTO Matthew Baird said AWS underpins the platform's AI-native design and unified data model, while AWS North America's Rich Geraffo positioned AWS as the foundation enabling agentic AI for property management with strong governance and scale.

Source: <https://press.aboutamazon.com/aws/2026/8/appfolio-names-amazon-web-services-its-preferred-cloud-provider>

Partnership**AWS**

Aug 14, 2026

Oracle and AWS Deepen Collaboration as Oracle AI Database@AWS Adoption Accelerates

Oracle and AWS expanded their strategic collaboration around Oracle AI Database@AWS, now available in 22 AWS Regions across Asia Pacific, Europe, and the Americas. The service offers a lower-cost migration path for Oracle databases with integration into AWS analytics and AI services. Enhancements include Exadata Database Service on Exascale infrastructure for elastic compute and storage, instant thin cloning, and broader AI-ready workloads, plus Oracle AI Vector Search, extending Exadata economics to smaller databases and multi-region deployments.

Source: <https://www.webwire.com/ViewPressRel.asp?ald=358911>

Announcement**AWS**

Aug 14, 2026

AWS Certificate Manager Sets 2027 End Date for Email-Validated Certificate Renewals

AWS Certificate Manager will phase out email validation for public TLS certificates, ahead of the CA/Browser Forum's March 2028 deadline. Email validation stops in new Regions January 1, 2027, ends for new certificate requests March 31, 2027, and renewals of existing email-validated certificates stop September 30, 2027. Customers can switch in place via UpdateCertificateOptions or the console without reissuing or changing the certificate ARN, adding CNAME records within 72 hours. AWS recommends DNS validation generally and HTTP validation for CloudFront.

Source: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/14/aws-certificate-manager-email-validation/>

Financial**Zscaler**

Aug 14, 2026

Zscaler Raises CapEx to Meet AI-Led Security Demand

Zscaler is increasing capital expenditures across fiscal 2026 and 2027 to support AI-driven cybersecurity demand, guiding CapEx to roughly 9% of revenue in 2026 with a possible 200-basis-point step up in 2027. Spending targets memory, storage, and processors, with some 2027 purchases pulled into 2026 to lock in pricing. Demand signals cited include Q3 FY2026 revenue up 25% year over year to \$850.4 million, ARR up 25% to \$3.53 billion, and AI Protect bookings exceeding \$100 million.

Source: https://www.sharewise.com/us/news_articles/Zscaler_Increases_CapEx_Can_AIled_Demand_Justify_Higher_Spending_Zacks_20260814_1653

Research**Citrix (NetScaler)**

Aug 14, 2026

Citrix NetScaler Pre-Auth Heap Overflow (CVE-2026-8452) Enables Root RCE as Public PoC Lands

Researchers published a working proof-of-concept for CVE-2026-8452, a pre-authentication heap overflow in NetScaler ADC and Gateway that allows unauthenticated remote code execution as root by abusing the SAML authentication handler and corrupting the packet-processing engine. Affected deployments include AAA virtual servers and Gateway configurations (SSL VPN, ICA Proxy, CVPN, RDP Proxy), rated CVSS 8.8, with no supported workarounds — only patched firmware (14.1-72.61, 13.1-63.18). Citrix Cloud services were already upgraded. A companion information-disclosure bug, CVE-2026-8451, was also being exploited.

Source: <https://cybersecuritynews.com/citrix-netscaler-heap-overflow/>

Product Launch**A10 Networks**

Aug 14, 2026

A10 Networks Debuts A10 AI Gateway as an Intelligent Control Plane for Enterprise AI Operations

Coverage detailed A10 Networks' general availability of the A10 AI Gateway, a centralized control plane for enterprise AI that unifies model routing, cost governance, policy enforcement, and real-time observability across AI agents, applications, and LLMs. It runs entirely inside the customer environment, supporting on-premises, private cloud, and air-gapped deployments, with per-request and per-model cost tracking plus hard usage limits per user or team. Unveiled at Black Hat USA 2026, it complements A10's TrojAI and ThreatX portfolio — positioning A10 directly against F5's AI gateway efforts.

Source: <https://www.telecompaper.com/news/a10-debuts-ai-control-plane-for-enterprise-use-cases--1579950>

Award**Radware**

Aug 14, 2026

Radware Named a Leader in QKS Group SPARK Matrix: API Security, 2026

Radware published analysis of its Leader placement in the QKS Group SPARK Matrix: API Security, 2026. QKS credited Radware for end-to-end API protection spanning continuous discovery, contextual testing, runtime posture management and active mitigation, plus real-time detection and blocking of API threats in production. The report also highlighted AI-driven detection of business logic attacks through workflow learning and sequence analysis, and flexible deployment via the SecurePath out-of-path architecture for complex multi-cloud and hybrid environments, including discovery of shadow and unmanaged APIs.

Source: <https://www.radware.com/blog/qks-named-radware-a-leader-in-api-security/>

Research**Barracuda Networks**

Aug 14, 2026

Barracuda: Access Has Become the Primary Cyber Battleground

Barracuda argued that in 2026 access is the new perimeter, drawing on its June 2026 SOC Threat Radar findings that most attacks begin by exploiting gaps in visibility, access management and security hygiene rather than advanced exploits. The company urged an assume-compromise posture centered on rapid detection of suspicious activity and limiting lateral movement by continuously validating every identity, connection and access request. Barracuda framed this as an opportunity for MSPs to shift cybersecurity from reactive support to proactive resilience.

Source: <https://managedservicesjournal.com/articles/the-new-cyber-reality-why-access-has-become-the-primary-battleground/>